

NKORE Biotherapeutics, Inc. v. Ryan

Proprietary activation of allogeneic natural killer cells into supercharged NK cells for oncology immunotherapy, including cytotoxicity, tumor-microenvironment persistence, and translation of preclinical results toward clinical trials.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-18	C.D. Cal.	2:26-cv-09211	Trade Secret

Prepared 2026-08-25. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	NKORE Biotherapeutics, Inc. v. Ryan
FORUM / DOCKET	C.D. Cal. / 2:26-cv-09211
FILED / TYPE	2026-08-18 / trade secret
PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket

VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

NKORE Biotherapeutics, Inc. v. Ryan, No. 2:26-cv-09211, filed 2026-08-18 in C.D. Cal..

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Ronen Michael Segal (professionally listed as Michael Segal) - Eagle Law Group, P.C.; named matter counsel. Segal is the only plaintiff attorney identified on the public docket and filed the complaint and all opening papers; Eagle Law identifies Michael Segal as its managing attorney with trade-secret litigation experience.

msegal@eagle.law - publicly listed on the [official firm biography](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

Proprietary activation of allogeneic natural killer cells into supercharged NK cells for oncology immunotherapy, including cytotoxicity, tumor-microenvironment persistence, and translation of preclinical results toward clinical trials.

Secondary-source limitation: This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control. [Open public synopsis](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 What activation cocktail, sequence, culture conditions, expansion, cryopreservation, gene editing, potency assay, or selection criteria define the alleged supercharged NK-cell platform?

What activation cocktail, sequence, culture conditions, expansion, cryopreservation, gene editing, potency assay, or selection criteria define the alleged supercharged NK-cell platform?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

02 Do the methods produce durable cytotoxicity, persistence, trafficking, and function in an immunosuppressive tumor microenvironment?

Do the methods produce durable cytotoxicity, persistence, trafficking, and function in an immunosuppressive tumor microenvironment?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

03 Which elements were publicly known in cytokine-induced memory-like, CAR-NK, or allogeneic NK literature, and what experimental evidence shows incremental value?

Which elements were publicly known in cytokine-induced memory-like, CAR-NK, or allogeneic NK literature, and what experimental evidence shows incremental value?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

Questions likely to require expert input

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Rizwan Romee

Associate Professor of Medicine, Harvard Medical School and Dana-Farber Cancer Institute

TECHNICAL FIT

Exceptional fit for memory-like and engineered NK cells, solid-tumor TME, persistence, and clinical translation.

RELEVANT WORK

Runs early-phase engineered memory-like NK trials and studies CRISPR editing, CARs, and transferred-cell behavior in the TME.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Active clinical and commercial collaborations require extensive conflict review.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | rizwan_romeo@dfci.harvard.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Melissa M. Berrien-Elliott

Assistant Professor of Medicine, Division of Oncology, Washington University in St. Louis

TECHNICAL FIT

Exceptional fit for cytokine-induced memory-like NK cells, translational immunology, tumor-microenvironment immune evasion, and clinical-sample analysis.

RELEVANT WORK

Her laboratory studies how cancer immunotherapies alter NK cells, how the tumor microenvironment drives immune evasion, and the enhanced functionality of briefly cytokine-activated memory-like NK cells.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Her public work is concentrated in translational immunology rather than commercial cell-product manufacturing; Washington University relationships require conflict diligence.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | melissa.berrien@wustl.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Dean Lee

Professor of Pediatrics and cellular-therapy program director, Ohio State/Nationwide Children's

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for ex-vivo expansion, genetic/non-genetic enhancement, solid-tumor suppression, and clinical-grade NK manufacture.

RELEVANT WORK

Developed robust clinical-grade NK expansion and first-in-human adoptive-therapy platforms.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Pediatric-tumor emphasis may not cover every adult oncology indication.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | lee.7991@osu.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Neil C. Sheppard

Director, Therapeutic Innovation in Natural Killer Cells Lab; adjunct associate professor, University of Pennsylvania

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for NK expansion, cryopreservation, gene editing, CAR design, checkpoints, resistance, and clinical development.

RELEVANT WORK

Former Pfizer/GSK/Tmunity drug-development leader who has led IND and Phase 1 programs.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Prior and current biotech relationships present substantial conflict-screening needs.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | neil.sheppard@pennmedicine.upenn.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Dongfang Liu

Professor/Associate Professor of Pathology, Immunology and Laboratory Medicine, Rutgers NJMS

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for NK/CAR-NK immunobiology, immunological synapses, live-cell imaging, and cytotoxic signaling.

RELEVANT WORK

Researches CAR-NK synapses, human cytotoxic lymphocytes, receptors, and cancer immunotherapy.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Less directly clinical-manufacturing focused than translational trial leaders.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | dl907@njms.rutgers.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Jianhua Yu

Professor of Medicine, University of California Irvine

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for CAR-NK, allogeneic therapy, NK signaling, solid/hematologic tumors, patents, and translation.

RELEVANT WORK

More than 260 publications and over 40 patents; founded a Natural Killer Research Program and translated discoveries clinically.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Broad patent and collaboration portfolio increases conflict complexity.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | jianhuay@uci.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Amir Horowitz

Assistant Professor of Oncological Sciences, Icahn School of Medicine at Mount Sinai

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for adaptive NK subsets, CyTOF characterization, immunogenetic variation, function, and therapeutic potential.

RELEVANT WORK

Pioneered high-dimensional human NK-cell profiling and characterization of functional subsets.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

More focused on immune diversity and profiling than cell-product manufacturing.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | amir.horowitz@mssm.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Colleen Lau

Assistant Professor of Immunology, Cornell University College of Veterinary Medicine

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for NK-cell memory, epigenetic programming, multi-omics, and activation-state persistence.

RELEVANT WORK

Studies antigen-dependent and independent NK memory using multi-omic and genetic models.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Preclinical/basic-science profile and limited public clinical-trial leadership.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | colleen.lau@cornell.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Kenneth DeSantes

Crawford Professor of Pediatric Oncology, University of Wisconsin-Madison

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for activated/expanded allogeneic NK cells, haploidentical infusions, CIML NK trials, and solid tumors.

RELEVANT WORK

Developed ex-vivo expansion/activation methodology and NK-cell clinical protocols in pediatric malignancies.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Pediatric focus and clinician commitments may narrow general adult-oncology opinions.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | kdesantes@pediatrics.wisc.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Frank Cichocki

Associate Professor of Medicine, University of Minnesota

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for human NK development, epigenetic control, transplantation, and clinical NK-cell immunotherapy.

RELEVANT WORK

Works within a consortium reporting hundreds of NK infusions and studies NK receptors and cancer therapy.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Institutional source visually suppresses punctuation in the address in some renderings; verify the clickable mail link before use.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | cich0040@umn.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/california/cacdce/2%3A2026cv09211/1034614>

Official attorney biography and email: <https://apps.calbar.ca.gov/attorney/Licensee/Detail/338841>

Public technical context source: <https://www.nkore.com/>

LIMITATIONS

This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control.

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